Loan Officer Credit & Per-Loan Cost Analysis

Reach Home Loans · Prepared October 15, 2026 · Data: January–September 2026

Summary

$495
Average credit cost per closed loan (all three LOs)

$230
Operations bonus per closed loan

≈$725
Credit + ops bonus per closed loan

- Credit cost per closed loan ranges from **$326** (Olmsted) to **$870** (Harold). The driver is how many pulls it takes to close a loan, not the price per pull.
- **Biggest lever: investor free credit pulls.** Olmsted moved to an investor's free pull option over the summer. His credit cost fell from **$471** to **$117** per closed loan (Section 5).
- A standard tri-merge costs **$89**, including joint reports. Harold's soft pulls cost **$75 single / $150 joint**, more than a standard pull.
- **Recommendation:** do not give soft-pull accounts to new outside loan officers at current vendor pricing (see Section 4).
- With investor free pulls (Olmsted, June–September), the per-loan figure falls to about **$347** ($117 + $230).

1. Method

- **Source:** credit vendor monthly statements for Joe Olmsted, Joseph Carey and Harold Ellis (two accounts: standard and soft pull). Every month was reconciled to the vendor's own monthly summary totals.
- **RMCR $250 charges are excluded.** They are recouped from the borrower at closing, so they are not a net cost to the company. Each RMCR line corresponds to a closed loan, and the RMCR counts closely match Salesforce closings, which supports the closing counts used here.
- **Payments are not costs.** Invoice payments and autopay lines are excluded.
- **Cost includes add-ons** such as rescores, report copies, tradeline updates and upgrades. A "pull" is a billed credit report (any bureau combination).
- **Closed loans** come from Salesforce: transactions where the LO is the assigned Loan Officer, with a closing date in the month and a status of Closing, Funding, PC Review or Post-Closed.
- **Period:** January–September 2026 (9 full months). October is partial and is left out of the averages.

Data notes

- **Carey, July:** the second half of the July statement is missing from the PDF; about $698 of charges is estimated.
- **Small samples:** Carey has 18 closings and Harold 30 over nine months, so one or two loans move their per-loan figures noticeably.
- **Timing:** pulls and closings are matched by calendar month. A pull in one month often belongs to a loan that closes one to two months later, so nine-month totals are more reliable than any single month.

2. Monthly pulls and net credit cost

Each cell shows billed pulls / net cost (after excluding RMCR and payments).

Month	Olmsted	Carey	Harold – standard	Harold – soft
January	41 / $3,677	18 / $1,561	19 / $1,715	8 / $875
February	33 / $3,022	12 / $1,144	18 / $1,623	6 / $451
March	42 / $3,786	11 / $1,056	18 / $2,563	24 / $2,001
April	41 / $3,677	9 / $979	17 / $1,619	22 / $1,650
May	31 / $2,804	7 / $633	24 / $2,143	11 / $900
June	12 / $1,068	11 / $938	25 / $2,572	14 / $1,275
July	9 / $822	5 / $1,157*	18 / $1,607	8 / $600
August	8 / $858	0 / $0	20 / $1,983	1 / $75
September	2 / $178	5 / $455	24 / $2,139	4 / $300
Total (9 mo)	**219 / $19,892**	**78 / $7,923**	**183 / $17,964**	**98 / $8,127**

* Carey's July statement is missing pages; about $698 of July charges is estimated from the statement's year-to-date total.

3. Averages per loan officer

Loan officer	Pulls / month	Credit cost / month	Closed loans (9 mo)	Pulls per closing	Credit cost per closed loan
Joe Olmsted	24.3	$2,210	61	3.6	$326
Joseph Carey	8.7	$880	18	4.3	$440
Harold Ellis (both accounts)	31.2	$2,899	30	9.4	$870
All three combined	**64.2**	**$5,990**	**109**	**5.3**	**$495**

Cost per closed loan

Component	Per closed loan
Credit reports (combined average)	$495
Processor bonus	$120
Processing team lead bonus	$40
Operations manager bonus	$60
Closer bonus	$10
Total	**≈$725**

Operations bonuses are paid on closed transactions only. Other per-LO costs (licensing, software seats, phone, lead spend) are not yet included.

4. Soft-pull accounts: should new outside LOs get one?

Harold is the only LO with both a soft-pull and a standard-pull account, so his data shows what soft pull does in practice.

Finding (2026 statements)	Result
Price of a soft pull vs. a standard tri-merge	$75 single / $150 joint vs. $89
Borrowers soft-pulled	106
… who later also got a standard pull (paid twice)	34 (32%)
Borrowers standard-pulled	154
… who had a soft pull first	40 (26%)
Pulls per closed loan: Harold vs. Olmsted / Carey	9.4 vs. 3.6 / 4.3
Credit cost per closed loan: Harold vs. Olmsted / Carey	$870 vs. $326 / $440

- **Soft costs more, not less.** At these prices every soft pull costs about the same as or more than going straight to a standard pull, so it cannot save money even when it screens out a borrower.
- **About a third are paid twice.** When a soft-pulled borrower moves forward, the file still needs a standard pull for underwriting.
- **It isn't used as a screen.** Three quarters of Harold's standard pulls had no soft pull first, so the soft account adds volume instead of replacing hard pulls.

> **Recommendation:** do not give soft-pull accounts to new outside loan officers at current pricing. Revisit only if the vendor offers a soft product priced well below the $89 standard pull. One single-bureau soft pull on Harold's account was billed at $24.75, which shows cheaper options exist. If soft pull is ever rolled out, use company-controlled sub-accounts that can be audited and switched off, since every pull still requires a permissible purpose and borrower authorization.

5. Investor free credit pulls

Over the summer Olmsted began using an investor's free credit pull option. His billed pulls fell from about 40 a month to 2 by September, while his closings held steady.

Olmsted	Billed pulls / month	Credit cost / month	Closed loans	Credit cost per closed loan
January–May (paid pulls)	37.6	$3,393	36	$471
June–September (investor free pulls)	7.8	$732	25	$117

> **Recommendation:** make the investor free-pull option the default for every LO on eligible loans, including new hires. If Carey and Harold matched Olmsted's summer rate, their combined credit spend would fall from about $3,780 a month to about $625. The fallback is the $89 standard pull through the company account, not a soft pull.

Because Olmsted's free pulls do not appear on the vendor statements, his nine-month average ($326) blends both periods. Use $471 as the paid-pull rate and $117 as the free-pull rate.